DAVID WATKINS

EXECUTIVE OPERATIONS | GLOBAL DELIVERY | PROFESSIONAL & MANAGED SERVICES

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EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Business-unit and services operations executive with 30+ years leading complex technology operations, strategic customer relationships, organizational change, and global managed delivery. Owned a $50M P&L and led a seasonal organization of approximately 1,000 people at scale through operating-model and service expansion. Develops leaders, establishes measurable customer and commercial outcomes, and connects product capabilities with adoption, service performance, and financial accountability. Sponsored practical AI adoption in testing and analytics while retaining human ownership of decisions.

SELECTED EXECUTIVE IMPACT

- Led a volatile, seasonal Experis Game Solutions business with approximately $50M P&L accountability and an organization of approximately 1,000 people at scale; managed aggressive capacity increases and reductions while protecting delivery, customer commitments, and margins.
- Built leadership and operating cadence across six Test/Program Directors, Strategic Innovation, and Operations; used KPIs, client reviews, escalation management, workforce forecasts, and financial signals to guide decisions.
- Created Strategic Innovation leadership and sponsored AI-assisted test planning, scenario generation, telemetry analysis, and synthesis of performance feedback; kept managers accountable for assessments and final decisions.
- At Microsoft, managed approximately $30M in annual Xbox Certification OPEX and reduced costs by 10% through a redesigned Premium Certification operating model.

CORE CAPABILITIES

Enterprise Transformation & Change Management | Leadership of Leaders | Strategic Accounts & Executive Advisory | P&L / ROI Accountability | Customer Success & Value Realization | AI Adoption Governance | Global Delivery & Managed Services | Cross-functional Operating Models | KPI / SLA / CSAT Governance | Commercial Growth & Expansion | Executive Escalations

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

MANPOWERGROUP / EXPERIS GAME SOLUTIONS | Managing Director / Head of Quality (previously Senior Director) | 2021–March 2026

- Owned approximately $50M P&L and delivery portfolios supporting Microsoft, Amazon, Meta, Pokémon, and other enterprise clients; served as executive escalation partner on delivery, commercial performance, and customer satisfaction.
- Led three Test Directors, three Program Directors, a Director of Strategic Innovation, and a Senior Operations Manager; built a Center of Excellence for tools, continuous improvement, analytics, reporting, and training.
- Led a seasonal delivery business requiring rapid scaling in both directions; established operating reviews, performance scorecards, capacity forecasting, service governance, and cross-functional corrective actions.
- Authorized and prioritized AI adoption in test planning, test-case creation, telemetry analysis, and performance-feedback synthesis; sponsored scenario-generation and coverage-analysis capabilities with human oversight.
- Launched delivery centers in Milwaukee and Budapest, coordinating facilities, workforce readiness, leadership onboarding, operating controls, and integration into the delivery model.
- Expanded strategic accounts by adding Meta and negotiating an exclusive services arrangement with Amazon; partnered with Sales, Finance, Recruiting, and clients on SOWs, pricing, rate cards, resource planning, and margins.
- Introduced compatibility testing, data analytics and telemetry, and mobile game testing readiness services to broaden the delivery portfolio.

KYMETA CORPORATION | Director, Customer Success Management & Global Connectivity Services | 2017–2019

- Served as Chief of Staff to the GM, working with commercial and executive leadership to align strategy, customer operations, and product/service readiness.
- Led commercial launch of KALO connectivity services, coordinating Product, Sales, Engineering, and Operations across launch readiness and customer delivery.
- Co-authored Customer Success and Quote-to-Cash operating models; established KPIs, SLAs, CSAT/NPS, Voice of Customer, and executive business reviews.
- Led cross-functional customer escalation improvements and redesigned the RMA process, reducing average turnaround by approximately two weeks.

ATOS CORPORATION | Senior Director, Operations & Managed Service Delivery | 2015–2017

- Led Microsoft-focused managed services and executive customer governance across identity/access management and IT operations.
- Turned around Tier 2/Tier 3 IAM service performance with leadership accountability, KPI/SLA controls, and corrective action; contributed to a three-year contract extension.
- Partnered on Azure migration strategy for test-data-center operations, aligning technical transition planning and customer service continuity.

COMPUCOM CORPORATION | Senior Director, Managed Service Delivery | 2013–2015

- Led 150–200-person managed-services and consulting organization, with six direct reports, supporting predominantly Microsoft enterprise engagements.
- Managed approximately $25M in annual revenue and supported approximately $5M in growth through account expansion and new delivery opportunities.
- Owned customer governance, escalations, commercial changes, RFP responses, staffing models, and executive business reviews.

DEV9 CONSULTING | Management Consultant, Project Management & IT Governance | 2012–2013

- Designed IT portfolio governance and stakeholder workflows for a transportation and maritime organization.
- Implemented Innotas portfolio management to turn executive governance requirements into repeatable processes.
- Coordinated requirements, implementation planning, training, and adoption across business and technical stakeholders.

VOLT SERVICES / WALT DISNEY COMPANY | Management Consultant, Technical Project Manager | 2012

- Led Agile web-services delivery for a Disney online franchise, coordinating development, release readiness, and deployment.
- Aligned distributed engineering teams on sprint execution, infrastructure provisioning, and performance testing.
- Managed technical dependencies and operational readiness across delivery milestones.

MICROSOFT CORPORATION | Progressive leadership in Xbox, certification, programs & publisher relations | 1992–2012

- As Principal Group Program Manager, led Xbox Certification operations and publisher escalations for major platform launches; managed approximately $30M annual OPEX and a blended employee, contractor, and vendor delivery model.
- Reduced certification OPEX by 10% through Premium Certification; introduced publisher segmentation and vendor performance frameworks.
- Previously led publisher account relationships, multi-million-dollar content agreements, game production/program teams, and test organizations across Xbox and Microsoft Games.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

BBA, Information Systems and Operations Management — University of Toledo | Microsoft Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900) | Six Sigma Yellow Belt | ITIL v3 ITSM training